

Session 13: The Headline Formula

Key Points...

1. Your headline is the "ad for the ad."
 - People skim headlines to decide what to read.
 - If the headline doesn't grab attention, it's VERY unlikely that the content will... so people "skip it."
 - A headline is literally the "ad for the ad" - so focus your attention on making it powerful.
2. Your headline has a big job, so give it all the help you can.
 - Headlines make or break advertisements and marketing pieces.
 - Headline writers are some of the highest paid writers at magazines, papers, etc.
 - You should invest as much time writing headlines, subheads and "bullets" as you invest writing copy.
3. Use high emotion value words and phrases.
 - Some words and phrases trigger stronger emotions than others.
 - "Lawyer" triggers a stronger emotion than "Attorney" - for instance.
 - What are YOUR high-emotion-value terms? What words are your prospects using?
4. Offer a promise of a result, a benefit, or relief in your headline.
 - People are motivated by Results, Benefits & Relief - so offer these key motivators.
 - Your Prospect can't hear about their wants, fears, desires, and challenges too much.
 - Your headline is the words at the top of a letter, but it's also the first words in a teleclass, video, etc.
 - Get your best stuff out up front.
5. Famous headlines that worked:
 - "How To Win Friends & Influence People."
 - "Do You Make These Mistakes In English?"
 - "How I Improved My Memory In One Evening."
 - "How A New Discovery Made A Plain Girl Beautiful."
 - "At 60 Miles An Hour The Loudest Noise In The New Rolls-Royce Comes From The Electric Clock."
6. Align and connect your headline to every part of your marketing.
 - One of the biggest "marketing blunders" that I see is a mis-alignment of headline, message, and offer.
 - Consider what you're going to ask your Customer to do at the end, then "align" your headline with that.
 - Make sure that all parts of your Marketing are connected, continuous and congruent.
7. When in doubt, start with the words "how to."
 - A tried-and-true formula for great headlines, subheads and bullets is to start with the simple words "how to."
 - Add Results, Benefits, and Relief after How To, and you're already writing great headlines.
8. Re-use your headline powers in your marketing.

- Headlines are concentrated "Marketing Power" - focused into a few words.
- Re-use this power throughout your Marketing in the form of Subheads & Bullets.
- Put them in every few minutes in your audios and videos too.